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Pedagogical content pack: intercultural learning activities for youth

Cultural Bridges: strengthening interculturality and social inclusion among youth

Erasmus+ Programme — KA210-YOU Small-Scale Partnerships in Youth
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Pedagogical content pack

Intercultural learning activities for youth

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of this pack

This Pedagogical Content Pack is the core educational deliverable of the Cultural Bridges project. It brings together a comprehensive collection of ready-to-use intercultural learning activities, session plans, and facilitation resources that were developed, tested, and refined during the project's activities — most notably the international youth exchange held in Warsaw, Poland, from 14 to 18 May 2025, which gathered 30 participants aged 18 to 30 from Spain, Poland, and France.

The pack is designed to be a sustainable educational resource on cultural diversity and combating discrimination, available for long-term use by schools, youth associations, community organisations, and any institution working with young people in multicultural contexts.

Every session plan in this pack has been field-tested with real participants during the Cultural Bridges exchange programme. The activities were subsequently refined based on participant feedback, facilitator observations, and partner debriefing sessions to ensure they are practical, inclusive, and impactful.

1.2 Who is this pack for?

This pack is intended for:

- **Youth workers** running intercultural projects, exchanges, or local activities with diverse groups of young people.
- **Educators and teachers** in formal and non-formal education settings who want to integrate intercultural learning into their programmes.
- **Trainers** delivering workshops on diversity, inclusion, anti-discrimination, or active citizenship.
- **Volunteer coordinators** working with international volunteers (e.g., European Solidarity Corps).
- **Community organisations** seeking structured activities for social cohesion and integration programmes.
- **Youth leaders and peer educators** who want to facilitate intercultural activities in their communities.

No prior expertise in intercultural education is required. Each session plan includes detailed step-by-step instructions, facilitator tips, and adaptation guidance to support first-time facilitators.

1.3 How to use this pack

The pack is organised into six modules, each covering a distinct thematic area. The modules are sequenced to follow a natural learning progression — from initial contact and group formation (Module 1) through deepening understanding (Modules 2 and 3), co-creation (Module 4), celebration (Module 5), and reflection (Module 6).

You can use this pack in several ways:

- **As a complete programme:** Deliver all six modules in sequence over 3.5 to 5 days for a full intercultural learning experience (as was done during the Warsaw exchange).
- **As individual modules:** Select one or two modules that match the needs of your group and the time you have available.
- **As individual sessions:** Pick specific sessions to integrate into your existing programmes, workshops, or curricula.
- **As a facilitation reference:** Use the session planning templates, energiser collection, and evaluation tools from the appendices in any educational setting.

Key icons used throughout:

- **Objectives** — What participants will learn or experience
- **Duration** — Total time needed for the session
- **Group size** — Recommended minimum and maximum number of participants
- **Materials** — Everything you need to prepare
- **Room setup** — How to arrange the space
- **Instructions** — Step-by-step facilitation guide
- **Debriefing** — Questions for reflection and group discussion
- **Adaptation tips** — How to modify the activity for different contexts

1.4 Important notes for facilitators

- **Safety first.** Some activities touch on sensitive topics such as privilege, discrimination, and personal identity. Always establish a safe space agreement at the beginning of your programme (see Module 1). Remind participants that sharing is voluntary and that they can step out if they feel uncomfortable.

- **Language considerations.** In multilingual groups, speak slowly, use simple language, and provide visual support (written instructions, drawings). Encourage participants to help translate for each other — this itself is a powerful intercultural learning moment.
- **Inclusivity.** Every session includes adaptation tips for participants with fewer opportunities, including those with physical or sensory disabilities, language barriers, or limited prior educational experience. Review these before each session.
- **Timing.** All time indications are approximate. Allow extra time for translation, group dynamics, and deeper discussions. It is always better to do fewer activities well than to rush through many.
- **Co-facilitation.** Whenever possible, work with a co-facilitator — ideally from a different cultural background than your own. This models intercultural cooperation and allows for better group management.

2. Pedagogical framework

2.1 Learning approach

The activities in this pack are grounded in **non-formal education (NFE)** — a learner-centred, participatory, and voluntary approach to learning that takes place outside formal curricula. NFE recognises that meaningful learning happens through experience, interaction, and reflection rather than through one-directional transmission of knowledge.

The following pedagogical principles underpin all activities in this pack:

2.1.1 Experiential learning and Kolb's learning cycle

All sessions follow David Kolb's experiential learning cycle, which posits that effective learning occurs through a four-stage process:

1. **Concrete Experience** — The participant engages in an activity, exercise, or experience (e.g., participating in a simulation, completing a group task, meeting people from different backgrounds).
2. **Reflective Observation** — The participant reflects on what happened during the experience, what they observed, and how they felt (e.g., debriefing questions, journaling, pair sharing).
3. **Abstract Conceptualisation** — The participant draws conclusions, identifies patterns, and connects the experience to broader concepts or theories (e.g., linking a privilege walk to systemic inequality, connecting a communication exercise to NVC theory).
4. **Active Experimentation** — The participant applies new insights to future situations, plans actions, and tests new approaches (e.g., designing a community project, committing to a personal action plan).

Each session in this pack explicitly addresses all four stages. The "Instructions" section covers stages 1 and sometimes 4, while the "Debriefing" section covers stages 2 and 3.

2.1.2 Intercultural learning model

Intercultural learning in this pack follows a developmental approach based on Milton Bennett's Developmental Model of Intercultural Sensitivity (DMIS) and the Council of Europe's model of intercultural competence. The modules are sequenced to support learners in progressing through the following stages:

- **Awareness** (Module 1) — Becoming aware of one's own cultural identity and the cultural identities of others.
- **Understanding** (Module 2) — Developing a deeper understanding of cultural differences, stereotypes, and systemic inequality.
- **Skills** (Module 3) — Building practical communication and conflict resolution skills for intercultural settings.
- **Action** (Module 4) — Applying intercultural competence to co-create inclusive community projects.
- **Celebration** (Module 5) — Valuing and celebrating cultural diversity as a resource.
- **Reflection** (Module 6) — Integrating learning and planning for continued growth.

2.1.3 Participatory and learner-centred methodology

All activities in this pack are designed to:

- Place the learner at the centre of the process, with the facilitator acting as a guide rather than an instructor.
- Encourage active participation from all group members, using varied methods (individual reflection, pair work, small groups, plenary discussions, creative expression).
- Respect diverse learning styles (visual, auditory, kinaesthetic, reading/writing).
- Be adaptable to different group sizes, cultural contexts, and settings.

2.2 Connection to European key competences

The activities in this pack contribute to the development of several European Key Competences for Lifelong Learning, as defined by the Council of the European Union (2018):

Key Competence	How This Pack Contributes
Multilingual competence	Activities in multilingual settings; participants communicate across language barriers
Personal, social and learning to learn competence	Self-reflection on identity, values, and learning; group collaboration; conflict resolution
Citizenship competence	Understanding of diversity, equality, human rights; active participation in democratic processes
Cultural awareness and expression competence	Exploration of cultural identities; creative expression; appreciation of cultural diversity
Entrepreneurship competence	Design thinking for social impact; project planning and pitching

2.3 Connection to Youthpass

Youthpass is the European recognition instrument for non-formal and informal learning in Erasmus+ Youth and European Solidarity Corps projects. Participants in Erasmus+ youth activities can receive a Youthpass certificate describing and validating the learning outcomes of their experience.

Each module in this pack includes explicit learning outcomes aligned with the Youthpass key competence framework. Facilitators can use the "Expected Outcomes" sections to guide Youthpass self-assessment conversations with participants.

Module 6 includes a dedicated Youthpass self-assessment guide that can be used at the end of any programme using this pack.

3. Module 1: breaking the ice — intercultural discovery

Duration: Half-day (approximately 3 hours including breaks)

Module overview: This module is designed for the first encounter between participants from different cultural backgrounds. It creates a welcoming atmosphere, helps participants learn each other's names, establishes group agreements, and begins the exploration of cultural identity. The activities move progressively from low-risk name games to deeper sharing about cultural backgrounds.

Learning outcomes for this module:

- Participants know each other's names and at least one personal detail about every group member.
- Participants have reflected on and articulated elements of their own cultural identity.
- Participants have identified commonalities and differences with peers from other cultures.
- The group has established shared agreements for a safe and respectful learning space.

Session 1.1: "The name game" — learning names through cultural storytelling

Theme: Names, identity, and cultural heritage

Objectives:

- Participants learn each other's names and their cultural significance.
- Participants begin to share personal stories in a low-risk setting.
- The group starts to form connections through the discovery that names carry stories.

Duration: 30 minutes

Group size: 10–35 participants

Materials needed:

- None (optional: name tags or stickers and markers)

Room setup:

- Chairs arranged in a large circle, with no tables. If the group is comfortable, participants can stand in a circle. Ensure there is enough space for everyone to see each other.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(2 min)** Welcome participants and invite them to stand or sit in a circle. Explain that this activity is about learning names, but not just names — the stories behind them.
1. **(3 min)** The facilitator begins by sharing their own name and a brief story about it. For example: "My name is Marta. It is a name my grandmother chose for me — she was named Marta too, and in my family it is a tradition to pass names from grandparents to grandchildren. In Polish culture, name days are sometimes celebrated more than birthdays, and my name day is on 29 July."
1. **(2 min)** Invite each participant to think for a moment about their own name: Who chose it? Does it have a meaning? Is it common or unusual in their country? Is there a story behind it? Do they have a nickname? Emphasise that any detail, no matter how small, is welcome. If someone does not know the story behind their name, they can share what they like or dislike about it, or what it means to them.
1. **(20 min)** Go around the circle. Each participant says their name clearly (and may repeat it or spell it for the group) and shares a brief story or detail about it. The facilitator models active listening and may ask a gentle follow-up question to the first few participants to set the tone (e.g., "That is a beautiful meaning — is the name common in your country?").
1. **(3 min)** After everyone has shared, the facilitator invites the group to try a "name round" — going around the circle again, but this time each person says the name of the person to their left before saying their own. This reinforces name learning with a light, playful energy.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What surprised you about the stories you heard?
- Did you notice any similarities between name traditions in different countries?
- How does it feel to share something personal about yourself at the very beginning of a programme?
- Why do you think names are important in intercultural settings?

Adaptation tips:

- **Large groups (25+):** Split into two circles to keep the activity within 30 minutes.
- **Online delivery:** Use a digital whiteboard (e.g., Jamboard or Miro) where participants can write their name and its meaning. Each person unmutes to share their story.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** For participants who may feel shy or have limited language skills, the facilitator can gently offer prompts: "You can simply say your name and

whether you like it or not — that is enough."

- **Language barriers:** Encourage participants to say their name in its original pronunciation and then in a phonetic approximation that others can use. This validates linguistic diversity.

Session 1.2: "Cultural bingo" — finding commonalities across cultures

Theme: Shared experiences, cultural curiosity, group bonding

Objectives:

- Participants interact with many different people in the group, not only those they already know.
- Participants discover unexpected commonalities across cultural backgrounds.
- The activity generates energy, movement, and laughter as a group bonding experience.

Duration: 45 minutes (15 min activity + 15 min debriefing + 15 min group agreements)

Group size: 12–40 participants

Materials needed:

- Printed Cultural Bingo cards (one per participant) — see template below
- Pens or markers (one per participant)
- A small prize for the first person to complete a line or full card (optional — can be symbolic, e.g., a sticker or piece of chocolate)

Room setup:

- Open space where participants can move freely and mingle. Remove chairs and tables from the centre of the room, or use a large corridor or outdoor space.

Cultural Bingo Card Template:

Create a 5×5 grid with the following prompts (or adapt to your group):

Column 1	Column 2	Column 3	Column 4	Column 5	
Row 1	Has visited more than 3 countries	Speaks more than 2 languages	Has a grandparent born in a different country	Likes spicy food	Has participated in a cultural festival
Row 2	Can say "hello" in 4+ languages	Has lived in another country	Loves dancing	Knows a traditional recipe by heart	Has experienced culture shock
Row 3	Has a friend from a different religion	Enjoys reading books from other cultures	**Free space**	Has celebrated a holiday from another culture	Plays a musical instrument
Row 4	Has volunteered in their community	Can name 3 dishes from another cuisine	Has been surprised by a cultural difference	Enjoys learning new languages	Has participated in an Erasmus+ project before
Row 5	Knows a song in a language they don't speak	Has a multicultural family	Has taught someone about their culture	Has experienced a misunderstanding due to cultural differences	Wants to travel to a country they have never visited

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(3 min)** Distribute Bingo cards and pens. Explain the rules: participants must mingle around the room and find someone who matches each description on the card. When they find a match, they write that person's name in the corresponding square. Rules: (a) you can only write the same person's name a maximum of two times on your card; (b) you must have a brief conversation with the person — not just ask "yes or no?"; (c) the first person to complete a full line (horizontal, vertical, or diagonal) calls out "Bingo!"

1. **(15 min)** Start the activity. Play upbeat background music to create energy. The facilitator should also participate and model the behaviour by approaching people and having genuine conversations. Call out time warnings at 10 minutes and 13 minutes.

1. **(2 min)** When someone calls "Bingo!" (or when time is up), bring everyone back together. Congratulate the winner(s) and optionally give a small symbolic prize.
1. **(10 min)** Debriefing — sit in a circle and discuss using the questions below.
1. **(15 min)** Transition to establishing **Group Agreements**. Explain that to have a safe and productive learning environment, the group will co-create a set of agreements that everyone commits to. Ask: "Based on what you have experienced so far, and thinking about the days ahead, what agreements do you think we need as a group to make sure everyone feels safe, respected, and included?"

Collect suggestions on a flipchart. Common agreements include:

- Respect when someone is speaking (active listening)
- Confidentiality — personal stories shared here stay here
- No judgement — curiosity instead of criticism
- Right to pass — no one is forced to share
- Speak from your own experience ("I" statements)
- Phones on silent during sessions
- Be punctual
- Take care of yourself and others

Once the group agrees on the list, post it visibly in the room for the duration of the programme.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- Which squares were easiest to fill? Which were hardest? Why?
- What was the most surprising thing you learned about someone?
- Did you find more commonalities or more differences with people from other countries?
- How did it feel to approach people you did not know?
- What does this activity tell us about cultural diversity?

Adaptation tips:

- **Small groups (under 12):** Reduce the grid to 4×4 and change the rule so that each person's name can appear up to three times.
- **Online delivery:** Use a shared digital document (Google Sheets or Miro board) and breakout rooms. Participants rotate through breakout rooms in pairs for 3 minutes each.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** If some participants have limited mobility, ensure the activity can be done seated, with others coming to them. If participants have low literacy, read out the squares aloud and allow verbal responses.
- **Language adaptation:** Translate the Bingo card into the languages of your participants, or use pictograms alongside text.

Session 1.3: "My cultural backpack" — sharing what defines our cultural identity

Theme: Cultural identity, personal heritage, self-reflection

Objectives:

- Participants reflect on the multiple elements that make up their cultural identity.
- Participants share aspects of their cultural background with peers from other cultures.
- The group develops a richer understanding of cultural identity as multifaceted and personal.

Duration: 60 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- A4 paper (2 sheets per participant)
- Coloured markers, crayons, or pencils
- Magazines for cutting out images (optional)
- Glue sticks and scissors (optional)
- A large paper bag or backpack as a visual prop (optional)

Room setup:

- Tables arranged for small group work (groups of 4–5). Each table should have art supplies. Ensure tables are spread out enough for comfortable conversation.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Introduction. Show the group a real backpack or paper bag. Say: "Imagine that you are going on a journey, and you can only bring things that represent your cultural identity — the things that make you who you are culturally. These could be objects, traditions, values, foods, languages, music, beliefs, places, or people that are part of your cultural heritage. This is your Cultural Backpack."

1. **(5 min)** Ask the group: "What do we mean by cultural identity? What are the different elements that can be part of someone's culture?" Collect responses on a flipchart. Typical answers include: language, religion, family traditions, food, music, festivals, values, history, geography, neighbourhood, generation, gender norms, clothing, art, stories, humour, education. Keep this list visible for reference.

1. **(20 min)** Individual work. Distribute paper and art supplies. Ask each participant to draw a backpack on their paper and fill it with 5–8 items that represent their cultural identity. They can draw, write words, or cut out images from magazines. Emphasise that artistic skill does not matter — what matters is the meaning behind each item. Play soft background music during this phase.
1. **(20 min)** Small group sharing. Divide participants into groups of 4–5 (ideally mixing nationalities). Each person presents their Cultural Backpack to their small group, explaining each item and why it is important to them. Encourage group members to ask curious questions. Allow approximately 4 minutes per person.
1. **(10 min)** Plenary debriefing. Bring the full group back together and facilitate a discussion using the questions below.
1. **(Optional)** Display all the Cultural Backpacks on a wall to create a "Gallery of Cultures" that remains visible throughout the programme.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- How did it feel to think about and share your cultural identity?
- Was it easy or difficult to choose only 5–8 items? What did you leave out?
- Did anything surprise you about what others shared?
- Did you discover any commonalities with people from other countries?
- How is your cultural identity different from your national identity?
- Is cultural identity fixed, or does it change over time? How has yours changed?

Adaptation tips:

- **Large groups (25+):** Keep small group sharing but skip the plenary sharing of individual backpacks. Instead, ask each small group to report on one commonality and one difference they discovered.
- **Online delivery:** Use a digital drawing tool (Canva, Google Slides, or simply pen and paper held up to the camera). Share in breakout rooms of 4–5 people.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** For participants who find drawing challenging, provide pre-cut images from magazines or printed picture cards that they can select from. Allow verbal-only sharing if writing or drawing is a barrier.
- **Time-saving variant:** If time is limited, reduce to 3 items per person and do the sharing in pairs rather than small groups.

Module 1: Facilitator notes

Preparation checklist:

- [ ] Prepare the room: circle for Session 1.1, open space for Session 1.2, tables for Session 1.3
- [ ] Print Cultural Bingo cards (one per participant plus extras)
- [ ] Prepare art supplies for Cultural Backpack activity
- [ ] Prepare a flipchart with the session schedule for the half-day
- [ ] Have background music ready (neutral, instrumental music works best)
- [ ] Prepare your own examples for each activity (your name story, your own Cultural Backpack)
- [ ] Have name tags available in case participants need them after Session 1.1

Facilitator tips:

- Your own willingness to share openly sets the tone. Be the first to share your name story and your Cultural Backpack with genuine vulnerability.
- During Cultural Bingo, watch for participants who are standing alone or seem hesitant to approach others. Gently bring them into a conversation with you or with someone who seems approachable.
- When establishing group agreements, let the suggestions come from participants as much as possible. Only add items they missed if they are essential (e.g., confidentiality).
- Be prepared for emotional moments during the Cultural Backpack activity — participants may share stories about migration, loss, or identity struggles. Acknowledge these moments with empathy and thank the person for sharing.

Expected outcomes (aligned with Youthpass):

- Personal, social and learning to learn competence: Participants reflect on their own identity and learn to express it to others.
- Multilingual competence: Participants navigate communication across languages.
- Cultural awareness and expression competence: Participants explore and articulate their cultural heritage.

4. Module 2: understanding diversity and fighting stereotypes

Duration: Full day (approximately 6 hours including breaks)

Module overview: This module deepens participants' understanding of cultural diversity, stereotypes, privilege, and systemic inequality. It moves from personal experience (the privilege walk) through analytical thinking (media analysis, the iceberg model) to creative expression (counter-narratives). The module is designed to challenge assumptions while maintaining a safe and supportive learning environment.

Learning outcomes for this module:

- Participants can identify how privilege and inequality operate in society.
- Participants can analyse how media representations create and reinforce stereotypes.
- Participants understand the difference between visible and invisible aspects of culture.
- Participants can create positive counter-narratives about misrepresented communities.

Session 2.1: "The privilege walk" — understanding inequality and privilege

Theme: Privilege, inequality, social position, empathy

Objectives:

- Participants experience, physically and emotionally, how privilege and disadvantage create unequal starting points in life.
- Participants develop empathy for people with different life circumstances.
- Participants begin to understand structural inequality beyond individual merit.

Duration: 45 minutes (15 min activity + 30 min debriefing)

Group size: 12–30 participants

Materials needed:

- A list of 15–20 privilege statements (see below)

- A large open space (at least 10 metres deep) — a corridor, outdoor area, or large room
- Tissues available (this activity can provoke emotional responses)

Room setup:

- All participants stand side by side in a straight line in the middle of the space, facing the same direction, with room to take at least 10 steps forward and 10 steps backward.

Privilege statements (read aloud by the facilitator, one at a time):

1. If your parents went to university, take one step forward.
2. If you grew up with more than 50 books in your home, take one step forward.
3. If you have ever felt unsafe because of your ethnicity, religion, or skin colour, take one step backward.
4. If you have ever been discriminated against because of your gender, take one step backward.
5. If your family owned the home you grew up in, take one step forward.
6. If you have ever had to skip a meal because there was not enough money for food, take one step backward.
7. If you can show affection for your romantic partner in public without fear of judgement, take one step forward.
8. If you have ever been bullied or harassed because of your identity, take one step backward.
9. If you have access to quality healthcare whenever you need it, take one step forward.
10. If one or both of your parents were ever unemployed, not by choice, take one step backward.
11. If you have travelled abroad for a holiday, take one step forward.
12. If you have ever felt that your language or accent was mocked or not taken seriously, take one step backward.
13. If you see people of your ethnicity widely represented in media (TV, film, advertising) in positive roles, take one step forward.
14. If you have ever been stopped or questioned by police because of your appearance, take one step backward.
15. If you feel confident that your voice is heard in political decisions in your country, take one step forward.
16. If your family has ever had to move or flee because of war, conflict, or persecution, take one step backward.
17. If you can easily find a mentor or role model from your cultural background in your profession, take one step forward.
18. If you have ever been told to "go back to your country," take one step backward.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(3 min)** Ask participants to line up side by side in the middle of the space. Explain that you will read a series of statements. For each statement, if it applies to them, they should take one step forward or one step backward as instructed. Emphasise the following ground rules:

- This is a silent activity. No talking, laughing, or commenting during the walk.
- Participation is voluntary. If a statement feels too personal, you can choose not to move.
- Be honest with yourself. No one is checking your answers.
- This is not a competition. There are no right or wrong positions.

1. **(12 min)** Read the statements slowly, one at a time, with a pause of 5–8 seconds between each. Speak in a calm, neutral tone. After each statement, give participants time to take their step and observe where they are relative to others.

1. **(2 min)** After the last statement, ask participants to stop where they are. Ask them to look around — look at who is in front of them, beside them, and behind them. Let the silence sit for 15–20 seconds. Then ask everyone to sit down where they are, forming a large seated group.

1. **(28 min)** Facilitate the debriefing using the questions below. This is the most important part of the activity. Allow ample time for participants to process their emotions and share their reflections. Start with feelings, then move to observations, and finally to analysis.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- How are you feeling right now? (Allow time for emotional responses.)
- What did you notice as you took steps forward or backward?
- How did it feel to be at the front? At the back? In the middle?
- At what point did you become most aware of the differences in the group?
- Did any of the statements surprise you?
- What does this activity show us about the starting points people have in life?
- Are the privileges and disadvantages in this activity the result of individual choices? If not, what creates them?
- How does privilege relate to intercultural encounters? How does it affect the way people from different backgrounds interact?
- What can we do — individually and collectively — about the inequalities this activity highlights?

Adaptation tips:

- **Sensitive groups or first-time facilitators:** You can reduce the intensity by framing statements more generally (about "people in your country" rather than "you personally"). However, the personal dimension is what makes this activity powerful.

- **Online delivery:** This activity is very difficult to replicate online with the same impact. As an alternative, create an anonymous survey with the privilege statements and display aggregate results (e.g., "8 out of 20 participants would have stepped back for this statement"). Discuss the patterns.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Be especially mindful that participants from marginalised backgrounds may find this activity confronting. Ensure the debriefing emphasises structural analysis rather than personal exposure. Offer individual support after the session if needed.
- **Physical accessibility:** For participants with mobility limitations, use a seated version where participants hold up coloured cards (green = step forward, red = step backward) instead of physically moving.

Important facilitation note: This is one of the most emotionally intense activities in the pack. Do not rush the debriefing. Be prepared for strong emotional reactions, including tears, anger, or withdrawal. Acknowledge all feelings as valid. If a participant becomes very upset, your co-facilitator can offer individual support outside the room. Always follow this activity with a break.

Session 2.2: "Media and stereotypes" — analysing how media portrays different cultures

Theme: Media literacy, stereotypes, representation, critical thinking

Objectives:

- Participants develop critical media literacy skills to identify stereotypical portrayals.
- Participants understand how media shapes public perceptions of different cultural groups.
- Participants explore how stereotypes affect real people and real communities.

Duration: 60 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- A curated selection of 8–12 media examples (printed or projected) — newspaper headlines, magazine covers, social media posts, screenshots from films or TV shows, advertisements. Choose examples that show stereotypical portrayals of different cultural, ethnic, religious, or national groups. Include examples from the countries represented in your group. Include both negative stereotypes and "positive" stereotypes (e.g., "all Asians are good at maths").
- Flipchart paper and markers for each small group
- Projector or printed copies of media examples

- Handout with analysis questions (see below)

Room setup:

- Tables arranged for small group work (groups of 4–5). A projector screen or wall for displaying media examples. Each table should have flipchart paper and markers.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Introduction. Ask the group: "What is a stereotype?" Collect definitions. Arrive at a working definition: a stereotype is a widely held, simplified, and generalised belief about a particular group of people. Ask: "Where do stereotypes come from?" Guide the discussion toward media as one of the main sources.

1. **(10 min)** Show the curated media examples one by one (projected or printed). For each, ask: "What do you see? Who is being represented? How are they being represented? What message does this send?" Do this quickly — 1–2 minutes per example — to build a sense of pattern recognition.

1. **(5 min)** Divide participants into small groups of 4–5 (mix nationalities). Give each group 2–3 media examples and a handout with analysis questions:

- What cultural group is being portrayed?
- What characteristics or behaviours are associated with this group?
- Is this portrayal realistic? Why or why not?
- Who created this media? Who is the intended audience?
- How might a member of this cultural group feel seeing this portrayal?
- What is missing from this portrayal? What other stories could be told?

1. **(20 min)** Small group analysis. Each group analyses their media examples using the questions, noting their findings on flipchart paper. Encourage them to draw on their personal experiences: have they ever seen their own culture stereotyped in media?

1. **(15 min)** Group presentations. Each small group presents their analysis to the plenary (3 minutes per group).

1. **(5 min)** Closing reflection. Ask: "What can we do as individuals to challenge media stereotypes? What role can young people play?" Collect a few responses.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- Were you surprised by any of the stereotypes you found in the media examples?
- Have you ever believed a stereotype because of something you saw in the media? What happened when you met someone from that group in real life?
- How do stereotypes in media affect real people and communities?
- Are "positive" stereotypes harmful too? Why?

- What responsibility do media creators have? What responsibility do media consumers have?
- How can we become more critical consumers of media?

Adaptation tips:

- **Context-specific examples:** Always use media examples from the countries and cultural groups represented in your participant group. Generic examples are less impactful than ones that resonate with participants' lived experience.
- **Online delivery:** Share media examples via screen sharing. Use breakout rooms for small group analysis and a shared Google Slides deck for each group to record their findings.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** If participants have limited media literacy, spend more time on the initial examples, guiding the analysis step by step. Use visual media (images, video clips) rather than text-heavy examples.
- **Trigger warning:** Some media examples may contain offensive content (racist imagery, sexist advertising, etc.). Warn participants in advance and emphasise that these are shown for critical analysis, not endorsement.

Session 2.3: "The iceberg model of culture" — visible vs invisible culture

Theme: Depth of culture, surface vs deep culture, cultural awareness

Objectives:

- Participants understand that culture has visible (surface) and invisible (deep) dimensions.
- Participants can identify examples of both visible and invisible cultural elements.
- Participants recognise that intercultural misunderstandings often arise from invisible cultural differences.

Duration: 45 minutes

Group size: 10–35 participants

Materials needed:

- A large drawing of an iceberg on a flipchart or projected image (showing approximately 10% above the waterline and 90% below)
- Sticky notes (two colours: one for "visible" culture, one for "invisible" culture)
- Markers
- Flipchart paper

Room setup:

- The iceberg image should be visible to all participants. Seating in a semicircle facing the iceberg, or standing around it.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Show the iceberg image. Ask: "What do you know about icebergs?" Guide participants to the key insight: only about 10% of an iceberg is visible above the waterline; the vast majority is hidden below the surface. Explain: "Culture is like an iceberg. Some parts of culture are easily visible — we can see, hear, taste, and touch them. But the largest and most influential parts of culture are invisible."

1. **(5 min)** Brainstorm visible culture. Ask: "What are the visible, easily observable aspects of a culture — the parts above the waterline?" Distribute sticky notes (one colour for visible). Participants write one idea per sticky note and place them above the waterline on the iceberg. Examples: food, clothing, music, dance, language, art, architecture, festivals, flags, greetings.

1. **(5 min)** Brainstorm invisible culture. Ask: "What are the invisible, harder-to-observe aspects of a culture — the parts below the waterline?" Distribute sticky notes (second colour). Participants write one idea per sticky note and place them below the waterline. Examples: values, beliefs about time, gender roles, attitudes toward authority, concepts of personal space, sense of humour, attitudes toward conflict, child-rearing practices, concepts of fairness, religious beliefs, notions of modesty, definition of "family," attitudes toward emotions, concepts of justice, work ethic, relationship to nature.

1. **(10 min)** Small group discussion. Divide into groups of 4–5. Give each group the question: "Think of a time when you experienced an intercultural misunderstanding or a moment of surprise when encountering another culture. Was the cause of the misunderstanding related to visible or invisible culture?" Each person shares one example in their small group.

1. **(15 min)** Plenary discussion. Invite 3–4 volunteers to share their examples with the whole group. Facilitate a discussion connecting their examples to the iceberg model.

1. **(5 min)** Synthesis. Highlight the key takeaway: most intercultural misunderstandings are caused by invisible cultural differences — different values, assumptions, and expectations that we may not even be aware of. Intercultural competence means developing awareness of both the visible and invisible aspects of our own culture and the cultures of others.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- Why is it important to look "below the waterline" when trying to understand another culture?
- Which invisible cultural elements do you think cause the most misunderstandings?
- Were you aware of all the invisible aspects of your own culture before this activity? Which ones had you not thought about?

- How can we become more aware of the invisible aspects of other cultures?
- What happens when we judge another culture only by its visible elements?

Adaptation tips:

- **Interactive version:** Instead of sticky notes, participants can draw or write directly on a large paper iceberg taped to the wall.
- **Online delivery:** Use a shared digital whiteboard (Miro, Jamboard) with an iceberg template. Participants add virtual sticky notes.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Use real-life examples rather than abstract concepts. For instance, ask: "In your family, who makes decisions? How do you show respect to older people? How close do you stand to someone when you talk?" These are accessible entry points to invisible culture.
- **Follow-up:** This session pairs well with Session 3.4 (Role-Play: Intercultural Misunderstandings), which explores the consequences of invisible cultural differences in practice.

Session 2.4: "Counter-narratives workshop" — creating positive stories about misrepresented communities

Theme: Counter-narratives, empowerment, creative expression, media creation

Objectives:

- Participants practise creating positive, nuanced stories about communities that are often stereotyped or misrepresented.
- Participants develop creative communication skills (writing, visual, or multimedia).
- Participants experience the empowerment that comes from telling your own story on your own terms.

Duration: 90 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- Flipchart paper and markers for each group
- A4 paper, coloured pencils, magazines for collage
- Smartphones or tablets (for groups choosing video or social media formats)
- Projector or display screen for final presentations

- Optional: printed examples of counter-narrative campaigns (e.g., #ActuallySheDoes, Humans of New York, "I Am Not a Stereotype" projects)

Room setup:

- Tables arranged for small group work (groups of 4–5), with art supplies on each table. A presentation area with a projector or wall for displaying posters.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(10 min)** Introduction. Explain the concept of counter-narratives: "A counter-narrative is a story that challenges a dominant narrative — a story that pushes back against stereotypes and offers a more complex, more human, more truthful picture of a community or group." Show 2–3 examples of real counter-narrative projects (projected or printed). Discuss what makes them effective.

1. **(5 min)** Brainstorm. Ask the group: "What communities or groups do you think are most often misrepresented or stereotyped in your countries?" Collect responses on a flipchart. Examples might include: immigrants, refugees, Roma communities, Muslim communities, rural communities, young people, people with disabilities, LGBTQ+ communities, people from specific neighbourhoods.

1. **(5 min)** Form groups. Divide participants into groups of 4–5 (mixing nationalities). Each group chooses one community or group from the brainstorm list (or proposes their own).

1. **(10 min)** Research and discussion. Each group discusses: What are the common stereotypes about this community? Why do these stereotypes exist? What is the reality? What positive stories, contributions, and experiences are overlooked? If any group members belong to or have connections with the chosen community, their personal perspective is especially valuable (but participation must be voluntary, never forced).

1. **(40 min)** Creation. Each group creates a counter-narrative in one of the following formats:

- A poster or infographic
- A short video or social media story (1–2 minutes)
- A spoken word poem or rap
- A short comic strip
- An open letter
- A photo essay (using their phones)

The facilitator circulates, offering support and encouragement. Emphasise that the goal is authenticity and impact, not polished production quality.

1. **(15 min)** Presentations. Each group presents their counter-narrative to the whole group (3 minutes per group). After each presentation, the audience can offer appreciation ("I liked..." or "I was moved by...").

1. **(5 min)** Closing reflection. Facilitate a brief plenary reflection using the questions below.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- How did it feel to create a positive story about a community that is usually stereotyped?
- What challenges did your group face in creating the counter-narrative?
- Do you think counter-narratives can change people's perceptions? Why or why not?
- What would it take for these counter-narratives to reach a wide audience?
- How can you apply this approach in your own community or on your own social media?

Adaptation tips:

- **More time:** If you have an additional 30 minutes, add a peer feedback round where groups give each other constructive suggestions before finalising their counter-narratives.
- **Online delivery:** Groups work in breakout rooms and use collaborative tools (Google Slides, Canva, or short video recordings). Present via screen sharing.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Offer the spoken word or verbal storytelling option for participants who may find writing or digital creation challenging. Pair participants with different skill sets (e.g., someone who can draw with someone who is a strong speaker).
- **Ethical considerations:** If the counter-narrative is about a community that is not represented in the group, encourage participants to research real voices from that community rather than imagining on their behalf. Centre lived experience over assumptions.

Module 2: Facilitator notes

Preparation checklist:

- [ ] Prepare and print privilege walk statements (adapt to your context)
- [ ] Scout the privilege walk space — ensure it is large enough and private
- [ ] Curate and prepare media examples for Session 2.2 (printed and/or digital)
- [ ] Draw or print the iceberg image
- [ ] Prepare sticky notes in two colours
- [ ] Prepare art supplies for counter-narratives workshop
- [ ] Find and prepare examples of real counter-narrative projects
- [ ] Prepare tissues and a quiet space for participants who may need emotional support
- [ ] Brief your co-facilitator on the emotional intensity of the privilege walk

Facilitator tips:

- Schedule a break between the privilege walk and the media session. The privilege walk is emotionally intense, and participants need time to process.
- During the privilege walk debriefing, resist the urge to "fix" or minimise emotions. If someone is upset, acknowledge it: "Thank you for sharing that. It takes courage."
- In the media and stereotypes session, be prepared for participants to challenge each other's perspectives. This is healthy. Guide the conversation by focusing on the impact of stereotypes rather than debating whether specific stereotypes are "true."
- The iceberg model is a foundational concept for the rest of the programme. Reference it repeatedly in later sessions ("Remember the iceberg — what is below the waterline here?").
- During the counter-narratives workshop, give groups freedom in their creative process. The facilitator's role is to encourage and support, not to direct.

Expected outcomes (aligned with Youthpass):

- Citizenship competence: Participants understand structural inequality, media influence, and the importance of representation.
- Personal, social and learning to learn competence: Participants reflect on their own privilege and biases.
- Cultural awareness and expression competence: Participants create counter-narratives using creative media.

5. Module 3: communication and conflict resolution

Duration: Full day (approximately 6 hours including breaks)

Module overview: This module builds practical communication and conflict resolution skills that are essential for intercultural settings. Starting with foundational listening skills, it introduces Marshall Rosenberg's Non-Violent Communication (NVC) model, explores conflict dynamics through the escalation ladder, and culminates in role-play scenarios that allow participants to practise what they have learned. The module is highly interactive and skills-based.

Learning outcomes for this module:

- Participants can practise active and empathetic listening, even across language barriers.
- Participants can apply the four components of Non-Violent Communication.
- Participants understand how conflicts escalate and can identify intervention points.
- Participants can navigate intercultural misunderstandings using constructive communication strategies.

Session 3.1: "Active listening challenge" — practising empathetic listening across languages

Theme: Active listening, empathy, non-verbal communication, language barriers

Objectives:

- Participants experience the difference between passive and active listening.
- Participants practise empathetic listening techniques (eye contact, body language, paraphrasing, asking open questions).
- Participants explore the challenges and opportunities of listening across language barriers.

Duration: 30 minutes

Group size: 8–30 participants

Materials needed:

- Timer or stopwatch
- A list of conversation topics (printed, one per pair) — see below

Room setup:

- Pairs seated face to face, with enough distance between pairs that they can hear each other without too much noise interference. Chairs only — no tables between partners.

Conversation topics (choose 2–3):

- "Tell me about a tradition in your family that is important to you."
- "Tell me about a moment when you felt like an outsider."
- "Tell me about someone who has had a big influence on who you are today."
- "Tell me about something you are proud of in your culture."

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(3 min)** Ask participants to find a partner — preferably someone from a different country or someone they have not spoken to much yet. Sit face to face.
1. **(2 min)** Explain: "We are going to practise listening — really listening. In everyday life, when someone is talking, we are often thinking about what we will say next, checking our phones, or waiting for our turn to speak. Active listening is different. It means giving your full attention to the speaker, trying to understand not just their words but their feelings and meaning."
1. **(5 min)** Round 1: "Bad listening." Assign one person as A (speaker) and one as B (listener). Give Person A a conversation topic. For 2 minutes, Person A speaks, and Person B deliberately demonstrates bad listening: looking away, checking an imaginary phone, yawning, interrupting, changing the subject. (This is meant to be exaggerated and humorous.) After 2 minutes, switch roles.
1. **(2 min)** Quick debrief: "How did it feel to be the speaker when your partner was not listening? How did it feel to deliberately not listen?"
1. **(8 min)** Round 2: "Active listening." Same pairs, new topic. This time, Person B listens actively: maintaining eye contact, nodding, leaning in, asking follow-up questions, paraphrasing ("So what you are saying is..."), and not interrupting. After 3 minutes, switch roles. After both have spoken, each listener summarises what they heard in one sentence to check understanding.
1. **(2 min)** Quick debrief in pairs: "What was different? How did it feel to be truly listened to?"
1. **(8 min)** Plenary debriefing using the questions below.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What is the difference between hearing and listening?

- What specific behaviours made you feel truly listened to?
- How is active listening affected by language differences? Is it easier or harder to listen actively when the speaker is using a language that is not their mother tongue?
- How can you show empathy through listening, even when you do not fully understand the language?
- In what situations in your life could better listening skills make a difference?

Adaptation tips:

- **Large groups:** The pair format works well for any group size. Just ensure the room is large enough or use multiple rooms.
- **Online delivery:** Use breakout rooms of 2 people. For the "bad listening" round, participants can turn off their cameras, type, or look away.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** For participants with hearing impairments, focus on visual forms of active listening (nodding, facial expressions, written notes). For participants with limited language skills, emphasise that active listening is primarily about non-verbal presence and that it is okay to listen without understanding every word.

Session 3.2: "Non-violent communication" — Marshall Rosenberg's NVC model applied to intercultural settings

Theme: Non-violent communication, expressing needs, empathy, conflict prevention

Objectives:

- Participants understand and can apply the four components of Non-Violent Communication (observation, feeling, need, request).
- Participants practise transforming judgmental or aggressive statements into NVC language.
- Participants explore how NVC can be used to navigate intercultural tensions.

Duration: 60 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- Flipchart paper and markers
- Handout: "NVC — The Four Steps" (see below)
- Handout: Practice scenarios (see below)
- Printed feelings and needs lists (available free from the Centre for Nonviolent Communication website)

Room setup:

- Semicircle for the presentation part, then tables for small group practice.

NVC — The Four Steps (handout content):

1. **Observation:** State what you see or hear, without evaluation or judgement. ("When I see/hear...")
2. **Feeling:** Express how you feel about what you observed. ("I feel...")
3. **Need:** Identify the need behind the feeling. ("Because I need/value...")
4. **Request:** Make a clear, specific, positive, doable request. ("Would you be willing to...?")

Example:

- Judgmental: "You are always late! You are so disrespectful."
- NVC: "When I see that you arrived 20 minutes after the agreed time (observation), I feel frustrated (feeling) because I need to feel that my time is valued (need). Would you be willing to call me if you are going to be more than 5 minutes late? (request)"

Practice scenarios:

1. Your roommate during the exchange plays loud music late at night. You have an important presentation the next morning.
2. During a group discussion, someone from another country makes a generalisation about your culture that you find inaccurate and offensive.
3. Your team is working on a group project, and one person is making all the decisions without asking for others' input.
4. A participant in your workshop keeps interrupting others and dominating the conversation.
5. You are at a dinner and someone serves you food that goes against your dietary restrictions (religious, ethical, or health-related), and they seem offended when you do not eat it.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(10 min)** Introduction. Ask: "Think of the last argument or conflict you had. How did you express yourself? What words did you use?" Collect a few examples (without getting into the details of the conflict). Note common patterns: blaming, generalising ("you always..."), labelling ("you are so..."). Explain that these patterns tend to escalate conflicts rather than resolve them. Introduce Marshall Rosenberg's Non-Violent Communication (NVC) as a tool for expressing ourselves honestly while maintaining connection with others.

1. **(10 min)** Present the four steps of NVC using the flipchart. Go through each step with examples. Show the contrast between judgmental language and NVC language using the example above. Distribute the handout.

1. **(5 min)** Practice together. Give one scenario to the whole group. Ask for a volunteer to express the situation using judgmental language first (for contrast), then guide the group to reformulate it using the four NVC steps together.
1. **(20 min)** Small group practice. Divide into groups of 3–4. Give each group 2 scenarios. For each scenario, the group must: (a) identify the observation, feeling, need, and request; (b) write out an NVC statement; (c) practise saying it out loud. One person plays the speaker, one plays the listener, and one observes and gives feedback.
1. **(10 min)** Plenary sharing. Ask 2–3 groups to share their NVC statements for one of the scenarios. The rest of the group can offer alternative formulations.
1. **(5 min)** Closing reflection. Discuss the questions below.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What was the hardest step in the NVC process? Why?
- How does NVC change the dynamic of a conversation compared to blaming or judging?
- How might NVC work differently in different cultural contexts? (For example, in cultures where expressing feelings directly is less common, or where making direct requests is considered impolite.)
- Can you think of a situation in your life where NVC could have changed the outcome?
- What are the limitations of NVC? When might it not be enough?

Adaptation tips:

- **Shorter version (30 min):** Skip the small group practice and do 2–3 scenarios as a whole group instead.
- **Online delivery:** Present NVC theory via slides. Use breakout rooms of 3 for the practice scenarios. Each group can use a shared Google Doc to write their NVC statements.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Provide the feelings and needs lists as visual aids, as many people struggle to identify and name their feelings. Use simple, relatable scenarios. Acknowledge that NVC is a model from a specific cultural context and that participants are invited to adapt it to their own communication styles.
- **Cultural sensitivity:** NVC was developed in a Western, individualistic cultural context. In some cultures, expressing personal feelings and needs directly may be unusual or even inappropriate. Discuss this openly and invite participants to consider how the principles (not the exact formula) might apply in their cultural context.

Session 3.3: "The conflict escalation ladder" — understanding and de-escalating intercultural conflicts

Theme: Conflict dynamics, escalation, de-escalation, intervention

Objectives:

- Participants understand how conflicts escalate through predictable stages.
- Participants can identify early warning signs of conflict escalation.
- Participants explore strategies for de-escalation at each stage.

Duration: 45 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- A large drawing of a ladder (or staircase) with 7–9 steps on flipchart paper
- Sticky notes and markers
- Handout: "The Conflict Escalation Ladder" (see below)

Room setup:

- Semicircle facing the flipchart with the ladder drawing.

The Conflict Escalation Ladder (based on Friedrich Glasl's model, simplified):

Stage	Description	Example
1. Tension	Disagreement emerges, positions begin to harden	"We see this differently."
2. Debate	People try to convince each other; language becomes more forceful	"You are wrong about this."
3. Actions instead of words	People stop communicating verbally and express frustration through behaviour	Ignoring, eye-rolling, slamming doors
4. Coalitions	People seek allies; "us vs them" groups form	"Can you believe what they did?"
5. Loss of face	Attacks become personal; the conflict is no longer about the issue but about the people	Name-calling, public humiliation
6. Threats	Intimidation, ultimatums	"If you do that, I will..."
7. Destruction	The goal is to harm the other, even at cost to oneself	Sabotage, violence, complete breakdown

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Introduction. Ask: "Think of a conflict you have witnessed — it could be between friends, in your community, or even between countries. How did it start? How did it get worse?" Collect a few brief examples to establish that conflicts rarely start at the most intense level — they escalate through stages.

1. **(10 min)** Present the conflict escalation ladder. Go through each stage on the flipchart, providing examples and asking participants to contribute their own. For each stage, ask: "What does this look like in an intercultural context?" For example, at Stage 4 (Coalitions), people may form groups along national or ethnic lines.

1. **(5 min)** Ask participants: "At which stage is it easiest to stop a conflict? At which stage is it hardest? Why?" Guide them to the insight that early intervention (Stages 1–3) is much easier and more effective than late intervention (Stages 5–7).

1. **(15 min)** Small group activity. Divide into groups of 4–5. Give each group a scenario:

- Scenario A: During a group project, two participants from different countries disagree about how to present their work. One wants a creative presentation, the other wants a formal one. The disagreement has reached Stage 3 — they have stopped talking to each other and are each doing their own version.
- Scenario B: During a shared meal, a participant makes a joke about another country's food. The person from that country feels offended but says nothing. Later, they make a sarcastic comment about the first person's country. Other participants are starting to take sides.

Each group must: (a) identify what stage the conflict is at; (b) identify what might happen if the conflict escalates further; (c) propose 3 concrete de-escalation strategies.

1. **(8 min)** Groups share their strategies. The facilitator writes de-escalation strategies on a flipchart, building a collective resource.

1. **(2 min)** Closing. Summarise the key de-escalation strategies and emphasise that intercultural conflicts are normal and can be opportunities for learning — if we address them early and constructively.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- Have you ever been in a conflict that escalated further than it needed to? What could have stopped it?
- Why do conflicts in intercultural settings sometimes escalate faster than in monocultural settings?
- What role does language play in conflict escalation? What happens when people cannot express themselves fully in a shared language?
- What de-escalation strategies work across cultures? Are there any that might not work in certain cultural contexts?
- What is the role of a facilitator or mediator in intercultural conflicts?

Adaptation tips:

- **More interactive:** Act out the escalation stages with a co-facilitator to make them more vivid and memorable.
- **Online delivery:** Present the ladder via shared screen. Use breakout rooms for the small group scenarios. Each group presents their de-escalation strategies via a shared document.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Use very concrete, relatable examples rather than abstract theory. Draw or act out the escalation stages rather than relying on text descriptions.
- **Follow-up:** This session connects directly to Session 3.4 (Role-Play), where participants can practise de-escalation in action.

Session 3.4: "Role-play: intercultural misunderstandings" — scenarios and resolution

Theme: Intercultural communication, misunderstandings, empathy, conflict resolution in practice

Objectives:

- Participants experience intercultural misunderstandings from multiple perspectives through role-play.

- Participants practise applying NVC and de-escalation strategies in realistic scenarios.
- Participants develop empathy by stepping into someone else's cultural perspective.

Duration: 90 minutes

Group size: 12–30 participants

Materials needed:

- Printed role cards for each scenario (see below)
- A "time-out" sign or bell for the facilitator
- Flipchart paper for recording observations
- Chairs arranged for a performance area and an audience area

Room setup:

- A "stage" area (clear space with a few chairs/props) and an audience area. Chairs for audience in a semicircle facing the stage.

Role-play scenarios:

Scenario 1: "The Meeting"

Context: A Spanish, Polish, and French youth worker are planning a joint activity. They are having a video call.

- Role A (Spanish facilitator): Expects a warm, relational start to the meeting — catching up personally before talking business. Expresses ideas passionately and speaks with hand gestures.
- Role B (Polish facilitator): Expects a structured, efficient meeting with a clear agenda. Finds personal chat during work time unprofessional. Speaks directly and concisely.
- Role C (French facilitator): Expects to discuss ideas philosophically and explore multiple angles before making decisions. Finds rushing to conclusions premature.

Conflict: Each person becomes frustrated that the meeting is not going the way they expect. They each interpret the others' behaviour negatively.

Scenario 2: "The Shared Kitchen"

Context: Participants from different countries share a kitchen during an exchange programme.

- Role A: Prepares food according to halal dietary requirements and is uncomfortable with pork being cooked in the same pots.
- Role B: Has brought traditional sausages from their country as a gift for everyone and feels rejected when some people will not eat them.

- Role C: Is vegan and frustrated that no one considered plant-based options in the meal planning.

Conflict: Each person feels their needs are not being respected. Tensions rise during dinner preparation.

Scenario 3: "The Group Project"

Context: A multicultural group of young people must create a presentation together.

- Role A: Comes from a culture where hierarchy is respected; expects the oldest person to lead and make decisions.
- Role B: Comes from a culture where consensus is important; wants everyone to vote on every decision.
- Role C: Comes from a culture where individual initiative is valued; goes ahead and starts working alone without consulting the group.
- Role D: Is quiet and hesitant because they are less confident in English; has good ideas but struggles to express them.

Conflict: The group cannot agree on how to work together, and they have a deadline.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Explain the role-play format. Participants will watch and participate in realistic scenarios of intercultural misunderstandings. The goal is not acting talent but genuine exploration of perspectives. Explain the "Forum Theatre" technique: the audience can call "Stop!" at any point during the role-play, step in, and replace one of the actors to try a different approach.
1. **(5 min)** Assign roles for Scenario 1. Give each actor their role card privately (they should not show it to others). Give them 3 minutes to read and internalise their role.
1. **(10 min)** Perform Scenario 1. The actors improvise the scenario based on their role cards. The facilitator lets the conflict develop for 3–5 minutes, then opens the floor: "STOP! What is happening here? What is each person feeling? Who would like to step in and try a different approach?" Audience members can replace any actor and attempt to de-escalate or resolve the situation.
1. **(10 min)** Debrief Scenario 1. Ask the original actors: "How did you feel in your role?" Ask the audience: "What invisible cultural differences were causing the misunderstanding?" Connect to the iceberg model and NVC.
1. **(20 min)** Repeat steps 2–4 for Scenario 2.
1. **(20 min)** Repeat steps 2–4 for Scenario 3.
1. **(15 min)** Final plenary debriefing using the questions below.

1. **(5 min)** Closing. Ask each participant to share one word that describes what they are taking away from this session.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What was it like to step into a role that was different from your usual behaviour?
- What happened when audience members stepped in with different approaches? What worked?
- Were there moments when you recognised yourself or your own culture in the role-plays?
- What communication skills were most useful in resolving the misunderstandings?
- How can we apply what we learned here to real-life intercultural situations?
- What is the most important thing to remember when you find yourself in an intercultural misunderstanding?

Adaptation tips:

- **Fewer scenarios:** If time is limited, do only 2 scenarios with deeper debriefing.
- **Custom scenarios:** Create scenarios based on real situations that have occurred (anonymised) during your exchange programme. This makes the learning deeply relevant.
- **Online delivery:** Role-plays can be done via video call with volunteer actors. Audience members use the chat to suggest alternative approaches, and the facilitator pauses the action to let someone take over.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Offer the option of being an "observer" rather than an actor for participants who feel uncomfortable with role-play. Their observations during the debriefing are equally valuable. For participants with limited language skills, provide role cards in their mother tongue and allow them to use their own language during the role-play (with translation support).
- **Emotional safety:** Role-plays can bring up real experiences. Remind participants that they can step out at any time. Debrief carefully, always separating the "role" from the "person."

Module 3: Facilitator notes

Preparation checklist:

- [ ] Prepare conversation topics for the active listening exercise
- [ ] Print NVC handouts and feelings/needs lists
- [ ] Draw the conflict escalation ladder on flipchart paper
- [ ] Prepare and print role cards for all three scenarios (keep in sealed envelopes)
- [ ] Set up the "stage" area for role-plays
- [ ] Prepare a "time-out" bell or sign

- [ ] Review all scenarios and anticipate potential sensitivities
- [ ] Brief your co-facilitator on who will manage which activities

Facilitator tips:

- The active listening exercise may seem simple, but it is foundational. Refer back to it throughout the day: "Remember what it felt like to be truly listened to."
- When teaching NVC, be honest that it feels unnatural at first. Say: "This is a model. You do not need to speak like this word-for-word. The goal is to shift your mindset from blaming to understanding."
- During role-plays, your role is to manage energy and safety. If a role-play gets too intense, call "Stop" and debrief. If it is too flat, inject a challenge ("Now Person B, you just received some bad news before this meeting — how does that change things?").
- End the day on a positive note. After the intensity of the role-plays, close with an energiser or a gratitude circle.

Expected outcomes (aligned with Youthpass):

- Personal, social and learning to learn competence: Participants develop self-awareness, empathy, active listening, and conflict resolution skills.
- Multilingual competence: Participants navigate communication across language barriers.
- Citizenship competence: Participants practise constructive participation in diverse groups.

6. Module 4: co-creating for inclusion

Duration: Full day (approximately 6.5 hours including breaks)

Module overview: This module shifts from learning about interculturality to acting on it. Participants map inclusion challenges in their own communities, use design thinking to develop project ideas that address these challenges, pitch their projects to the group, and create a creative "Message to the Future" as a legacy of the programme. This module was a highlight of the Warsaw exchange, where it culminated in a presentation supported by Fundacja Porta.

Learning outcomes for this module:

- Participants can identify specific inclusion challenges in their local communities.
- Participants can apply design thinking methodology to develop project ideas for social impact.
- Participants can present a project idea clearly and persuasively.
- Participants express their vision for an inclusive future through creative media.

Session 4.1: "Community mapping" — identifying local inclusion challenges

Theme: Community analysis, inclusion, social exclusion, local realities

Objectives:

- Participants analyse inclusion and exclusion dynamics in their own communities.
- Participants identify specific groups or areas that face exclusion.
- Participants share and compare inclusion challenges across different countries.

Duration: 45 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- Large sheets of paper (A1 or flipchart size) — one per group
- Coloured markers, stickers, sticky notes
- Printed guiding questions (see below)

Room setup:

- Tables for small group work (groups of 4–5 by country or mixed, depending on objectives).

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Introduction. Explain: "Before we can create projects that promote inclusion, we need to understand the challenges. Today we start by mapping our own communities — identifying who is included, who is excluded, and why." Clarify that "community" can mean their neighbourhood, city, school, university, organisation, or any community they are part of.

1. **(5 min)** Form groups. For this activity, groups by country often work well, as participants can map a shared community. Alternatively, mix nationalities and have each person map their own community, then compare.

1. **(25 min)** Community mapping. Each group draws a map of their community on the large paper. This is not a geographical map (though it can include geographical elements) but a social map. They should identify and illustrate:

- Who lives in this community? What groups are present?
- Where do people meet and interact across cultures?
- Who is included in community life? Who participates in decisions, activities, public spaces?
- Who is excluded or marginalised? Why? What barriers exist? (Think about: language barriers, economic barriers, physical accessibility, discrimination, lack of information, cultural barriers, legal barriers.)
- What resources or organisations already exist that promote inclusion?
- What is missing? What needs are unmet?

Use guiding questions printed on a handout:

- Who are the most vulnerable or marginalised groups in your community?
- What spaces or institutions are accessible to everyone? Which are not?
- What role do young people play in inclusion or exclusion?
- What has changed in recent years (for better or worse)?

1. **(10 min)** Gallery walk and cross-pollination. Groups display their maps. All participants walk around, view the maps from other groups, and add sticky notes with questions, comments, or observations (e.g., "We have the same challenge in our city!" or "Have you considered the Roma community?").

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What inclusion challenges are common across all the communities represented here?
- What challenges are specific to certain countries or contexts?
- Were there any exclusion dynamics you had not thought about before?

- What role do young people play — as both included/excluded people and as agents of change?
- Which challenges feel most urgent? Which feel most solvable?

Adaptation tips:

- **Online delivery:** Use a collaborative digital whiteboard (Miro, Mural) for the mapping. Each group works on a separate board and then visits others' boards.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** If participants have limited knowledge of their community structures, provide factual prompts (statistics, news articles) about common exclusion issues in their country.
- **Mixed groups:** If groups are mixed by nationality, have each person first draw a mini-map of their own community (5 min), then share with the group and identify common themes.

Session 4.2: "Design thinking for social impact" — using design thinking to create community projects

Theme: Design thinking, social entrepreneurship, project development, teamwork

Objectives:

- Participants learn and apply the five stages of design thinking (empathise, define, ideate, prototype, test).
- Participants develop a concrete project idea that addresses an inclusion challenge identified in Session 4.1.
- Participants experience collaborative, creative problem-solving in a multicultural team.

Duration: 120 minutes

Group size: 12–30 participants (groups of 4–5)

Materials needed:

- Flipchart paper (3–4 sheets per group)
- Markers, coloured pencils, sticky notes
- Craft materials for prototyping: cardboard, tape, scissors, magazines, string, modelling clay, LEGO bricks — anything creative
- Timer
- Handout: "Design Thinking — The 5 Stages" (see below)
- Project canvas template (see below)

Room setup:

- Tables for small group work, well stocked with materials. A clear wall or board for each group to display their work. Extra space for standing and moving around.

Design Thinking — The 5 Stages (handout content):

1. **Empathise:** Understand the people you are designing for. What are their needs, fears, hopes?
2. **Define:** Clearly state the problem you want to solve. Write a problem statement.
3. **Ideate:** Generate as many ideas as possible. No idea is too crazy. Quantity over quality at this stage.
4. **Prototype:** Build a quick, rough model of your best idea. Make it tangible.
5. **Test:** Present your prototype and get feedback. Iterate.

Project canvas template:

Element	Description
Project name	A catchy, memorable name
The problem	What inclusion challenge does your project address?
Target group	Who will benefit from your project?
The idea	What will you do? Describe your project in 3 sentences.
Activities	What specific activities will you organise?
Expected impact	What change do you hope to create?
Partners	Who could you collaborate with?
Resources needed	What do you need (money, space, volunteers, materials)?
First step	What is the very first thing you need to do to start?

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(10 min)** Introduction to design thinking. Present the five stages briefly (the goal is to give enough understanding to work with, not to deliver a lecture). Emphasise: design thinking is about starting with people and their needs, being creative and bold, and learning by doing.

1. **(5 min)** Form groups. Create groups of 4–5, mixing nationalities. Each group will develop one project idea.

1. **(15 min)** Stage 1: Empathise. Each group chooses an inclusion challenge from the community mapping exercise. They then spend 15 minutes exploring the needs of the people affected by

this challenge. Ask: "Who is excluded? What do they experience daily? What do they need? What do they wish existed?" Groups can draw empathy maps (what the person thinks, feels, says, does) on flipchart paper.

1. **(10 min)** Stage 2: Define. Each group writes a clear problem statement on a sticky note: "Young [target group] in [location] need [need] because [reason], but currently [barrier]." This becomes their design challenge.

1. **(20 min)** Stage 3: Ideate. Each group brainstorms as many project ideas as possible that could address their problem statement. Rules: no judging ideas during brainstorming, build on each other's ideas, go for quantity, think wild. Write each idea on a separate sticky note. After brainstorming, each group votes (each person gets 3 votes) to select the most promising idea.

1. **(30 min)** Stage 4: Prototype. Each group develops their selected idea into a concrete project concept. They fill in the project canvas and create a visual prototype — this could be a poster, a model, a mockup of a social media campaign, a storyboard of an event, or even a short skit demonstrating how their project would work. Use the craft materials creatively.

1. **(5 min)** Prepare for presentations. Each group prepares a 5-minute pitch for Session 4.3.

1. **(25 min)** Buffer time. Groups continue working on prototypes, rehearse pitches, and refine their project canvases. Facilitators circulate and offer support, asking probing questions: "Who specifically is your target group? How will you reach them? What makes your project different from what already exists?"

Debriefing/reflection questions (held after Session 4.3):

- See Session 4.3 debriefing questions.

Adaptation tips:

- **Shorter version (90 min):** Reduce ideation to 10 minutes and prototype to 20 minutes. Skip the empathy map and go directly to defining the problem based on the community mapping.
- **Online delivery:** Use digital collaboration tools (Miro, Mural, or Google Jamboard) for all stages. Groups work in breakout rooms and return to the main room for transitions between stages.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Provide concrete examples of youth-led inclusion projects to inspire ideation. If participants have limited project experience, pair them with more experienced peers. Emphasise that the project does not need to be perfect — it needs to be meaningful.
- **Real follow-up:** If possible, connect the best project ideas to real funding opportunities (e.g., Erasmus+ Youth Participation Activities, local grants) to give the exercise real-world stakes.

Session 4.3: "Project pitch" — groups present their projects

Theme: Public speaking, persuasion, feedback, project development

Objectives:

- Participants practise presenting a project idea clearly and persuasively.
- Participants give and receive constructive feedback.
- The group collectively explores a range of approaches to promoting inclusion.

Duration: 60 minutes

Group size: 12–30 participants (same groups as Session 4.2)

Materials needed:

- Timer
- Feedback cards or sticky notes for audience feedback
- Projector (if groups have digital presentations)
- A bell or sound to signal time

Room setup:

- "Pitch arena" — all chairs facing a presentation area. Each group's prototype/poster should be displayable. A "jury" table (optional — see adaptation tips).

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Set the scene. Explain: "Each group will now present their project to the whole group. You have 5 minutes to pitch your project. Imagine you are presenting to a panel of funders or community leaders. Be clear, be passionate, and be concrete." Explain the feedback process: after each pitch, the audience will have 3 minutes for questions and constructive feedback.
1. **(40 min)** Pitches. Each group presents (5 min pitch + 3 min Q&A/feedback). The facilitator keeps time strictly. After each pitch, invite 2–3 questions or feedback comments from the audience. Encourage feedback that is constructive: "I liked... because..." and "I wonder if you have considered..."
1. **(10 min)** Audience appreciation. After all pitches, distribute 3 sticky notes to each participant. Ask them to write one appreciative comment for three different groups and place them on the respective groups' posters. This ensures that every group receives positive recognition.
1. **(5 min)** Plenary debriefing.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What was it like to present your idea to the group?

- Which project ideas felt most feasible? Most impactful? Most innovative?
- What did you learn from the feedback you received?
- Could any of these projects be implemented in your real community? What would it take?
- How did the multicultural composition of your group influence the project you developed?
- What role can international cooperation play in promoting local inclusion?

Adaptation tips:

- **Guest jury:** Invite local youth workers, NGO representatives, or community leaders to serve as a "jury" and give feedback. During the Warsaw exchange, a representative from Fundacja Porta attended and provided expert input.
- **Online delivery:** Groups present via screen sharing. Use the chat for audience questions and reactions.
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Allow groups to present in whatever format they are most comfortable with — a poster walk, a skit, a spoken presentation, or even a song. Not everyone is comfortable with formal pitching.
- **Awards:** Optionally, introduce fun, non-competitive categories: "Most creative," "Most feasible," "Most impactful," "Best teamwork" — give an award to every group.

Session 4.4: "Message to the future" — creative expression: poster, video, or open letter

Theme: Creative expression, future vision, legacy, commitment

Objectives:

- Participants express their vision for an inclusive, intercultural future.
- Participants create a lasting creative output that captures the spirit of the programme.
- Participants reflect on what they have learned and commit to carrying it forward.

Duration: 60 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants (individual, pairs, or small groups — participant choice)

Materials needed:

- A4 and A3 paper
- Markers, coloured pencils, paints (if available)
- Magazines for collage
- Smartphones or tablets for video messages

- Envelopes and paper for letters
- Background music (calm, inspiring)
- A display wall or string with clips for hanging finished works

Room setup:

- Creative workshop format: tables with art supplies spread across the room. Different "stations" for different media (poster station, letter-writing station, video corner). A calm, creative atmosphere with soft background music.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(5 min)** Introduction. Say: "In this session, you are creating a 'Message to the Future.' This is a message from you — right now, after everything you have experienced and learned during this programme — to the world, to young people, to your future self, or to your community. Your message should capture what you believe about cultural diversity, inclusion, and the future you want to help build."

1. **(5 min)** Explain the format options:

- **Poster or artwork:** A visual message using drawing, painting, collage, or mixed media.
- **Open letter:** A written letter addressed to "the world," "young people in 2030," "decision-makers," or "my future self."
- **Video message:** A 1–2 minute video recorded on a phone. Can be a spoken message, a short poem, or a visual montage.
- **Spoken word / poem:** A piece of creative writing to be read aloud.

Participants choose their format and can work individually, in pairs, or in small groups.

1. **(40 min)** Creation time. Participants work on their messages. The facilitator circulates, offering encouragement and support. Do not direct the content — this is a space for personal expression. Play background music.

1. **(10 min)** Sharing. Invite volunteers to share their messages with the group. Not everyone needs to present — some may prefer to display their work silently. Create a "Message to the Future Gallery" on the wall where all works are displayed.

Debriefing/reflection questions:

- What message was most important for you to express? Why?
- How did the creative process feel? Was it easy or difficult to put your thoughts into a creative form?
- If someone from the future read or watched your message, what would they learn about this programme and this generation of young people?
- How can you carry this message forward in your daily life?

Adaptation tips:

- **Time capsule:** Collect all messages in a "time capsule" (a decorated box) and agree to open it at a future reunion or at the end of the project. Alternatively, scan or photograph all messages and create a digital archive.
- **Online delivery:** Participants create digital messages (Canva posters, short video recordings, written reflections) and share them in a shared Google Drive folder or virtual gallery (e.g., Padlet).
- **Participants with fewer opportunities:** Offer multiple format options so that everyone can express themselves in a way that feels comfortable. For participants who struggle with writing, the visual or verbal options are ideal.
- **Link to dissemination:** With participant permission, these messages can be shared on social media, websites, or in project publications as powerful testimonials.

Module 4: Facilitator notes

Preparation checklist:

- [ ] Prepare large paper sheets and art supplies for community mapping
- [ ] Print project canvas templates (one per group)
- [ ] Gather craft and prototyping materials
- [ ] Prepare the design thinking handout
- [ ] Set up presentation area and timer
- [ ] Prepare creative supplies for Message to the Future
- [ ] Prepare background music playlists (one energising for design thinking, one calm for creative session)
- [ ] If inviting a guest for the pitches, confirm their attendance and brief them

Facilitator tips:

- Community mapping can be emotional for participants who come from communities facing serious exclusion challenges. Hold space for this and validate their experiences.
- During design thinking, your role is to keep energy high, keep groups on track with timing, and ask challenging questions. Push groups beyond surface-level ideas: "How is this different from what already exists? Who is not included in your project? What could go wrong?"
- For the pitches, create a supportive atmosphere. This may be the first time some participants present in English or in front of a group. Celebrate every pitch warmly.

- Message to the Future is a reflective, emotional activity. Place it at the end of the day, after the high energy of the pitches. Let the mood shift naturally to something quieter and more personal.

Expected outcomes (aligned with Youthpass):

- Entrepreneurship competence: Participants design and pitch social impact projects.
- Citizenship competence: Participants analyse community inclusion challenges and propose solutions.
- Cultural awareness and expression competence: Participants express their vision creatively.
- Personal, social and learning to learn competence: Participants collaborate in multicultural teams.

7. Module 5: intercultural celebration

Duration: Evening programme (approximately 3 hours)

Module overview: The Intercultural Night is a celebration of cultural diversity where participants share food, music, dance, traditions, stories, and other aspects of their cultures in a festive, informal setting. During the Warsaw exchange, the Intercultural Night was one of the most memorable and bonding moments of the programme. This module provides a complete guide to organising one.

How to organise an intercultural night

Concept

An Intercultural Night is an evening event where each country or cultural group has a "station" or "table" where they present and share elements of their culture — typically food, but also music, objects, traditional clothing, games, and stories. The evening is festive, not academic. It is a celebration, not a lesson.

Planning checklist

2 weeks before:

- [ ] Announce the Intercultural Night to participants and explain the concept.
- [ ] Ask each country/cultural group to plan what they want to share (food, music, activities, decorations).
- [ ] Discuss budget: will the programme provide funds for food ingredients, or will participants bring items from home?
- [ ] Check for dietary restrictions and allergies among all participants.
- [ ] Book a suitable space (large room, outdoor area, or kitchen with dining space).

1 week before:

- [ ] Confirm what each group is preparing. Offer support for shopping and cooking.
- [ ] Arrange for music equipment (speakers, microphone, music playlists).
- [ ] Prepare decorations: flags, tablecloths, printed country signs, fairy lights.

- [ ] Plan a rough programme for the evening (welcome, open time for visiting stations, performances, dancing, closing).
- [ ] Assign responsibilities: who MC's the evening? Who manages music? Who takes photos?

Day of the event:

- [ ] Set up the space: one station (table + wall space) per country/cultural group. Each station should have a sign with the country name.
- [ ] Cooking time: allow 2–3 hours for groups to prepare food (schedule accordingly).
- [ ] Decorate the space with a mix of cultural elements and project branding.
- [ ] Set up music equipment and test it.
- [ ] Brief the MC (can be a participant volunteer or facilitator).

Suggested programme for the evening

Time	Activity
18:00–19:00	Cooking and preparation time
19:00–19:15	Welcome and opening by the MC
19:15–20:30	Open visit: participants walk freely between stations, taste food, ask questions, try activities
20:30–21:15	Performances: each group shares a song, dance, game, or presentation (5–7 min per group)
21:15–22:00	Free time: music, dancing, socialising
22:00	Closing: group photo, thank-you round

Tips for inclusive cultural sharing

- **Avoid tokenism.** Encourage participants to share aspects of their culture that are personally meaningful, not just the most "exotic" or touristic elements. A family recipe is more powerful than a generic national dish.
- **Be mindful of appropriation.** Sharing is welcome; copying or mocking is not. If someone wants to try a traditional dance, it should be with the invitation and guidance of someone from that culture.
- **Include everyone.** Some participants may not have a strong connection to a single national culture (e.g., children of immigrants, people from multicultural families, or people who have

lived in many countries). They should feel welcome to share whatever aspects of their identity feel right, or to simply enjoy the evening as guests at every station.

- **Food safety.** Label all foods with ingredients (for allergies and dietary restrictions). Include vegetarian and halal options. Provide serving utensils so people do not need to touch food with their hands.
- **Music and noise.** Balance live music and performances with quieter moments for conversation. Not everyone is comfortable with very loud music.
- **Documentation.** Take photos and short videos (with participant consent) for project documentation and social media. Designate a "photographer" so that facilitators can focus on hosting.

Reflection prompts (for the following morning)

Use these prompts in the next day's morning check-in to process the Intercultural Night experience:

- What was the most memorable moment of last night for you?
- Did you discover something about another culture that surprised you?
- What did it feel like to share your own culture with others?
- Did you notice any moments of connection across cultures?
- Is there something from another culture that you would like to bring into your own life?

8. Module 6: evaluation and reflection

Duration: Varies — integrated throughout the programme and with a dedicated final session (2 hours)

Module overview: Evaluation and reflection are not just activities for the end of a programme — they are an integral part of the learning process. This module provides tools for daily reflection, mid-programme check-ins, and a comprehensive final evaluation, as well as a guide for Youthpass self-assessment.

Daily reflection methods

These short activities (10–15 minutes each) can be used at the end of each day or at the beginning of the following morning to help participants process their experiences.

Method 1: mood meter

Duration: 5 minutes

How it works: Draw a large "mood meter" on a flipchart — a grid with "Energy level" on the Y-axis (low to high) and "Mood" on the X-axis (negative to positive), creating four quadrants:

Low energy	High energy	
Positive mood	Calm, content, relaxed	Excited, enthusiastic, inspired
Negative mood	Tired, sad, withdrawn	Frustrated, anxious, overwhelmed

Each participant places a sticky dot or writes their name in the quadrant that best represents how they are feeling. The facilitator reads the overall picture without commenting on individual positions. If many participants are in the "negative" quadrants, the facilitator can open a brief conversation: "I notice some of us are feeling [tired/frustrated]. Is there anything we can adjust?"

Method 2: roses and thorns

Duration: 10–15 minutes

How it works: Each participant shares:

- One "rose" (something positive from the day — something they learned, enjoyed, or appreciated)
- One "thorn" (something challenging, confusing, or uncomfortable from the day)
- One "bud" (something they are looking forward to tomorrow)

This can be done in plenary (for groups up to 15) or in small circles (for larger groups). The facilitator listens without judging or problem-solving. If a "thorn" points to a legitimate issue (e.g., scheduling, group dynamics), the facilitator can address it after the session.

Method 3: One-word check-out

Duration: 5 minutes

How it works: Standing in a circle, each participant says one single word that describes how they are feeling or what they are taking away from the day. No explanations, no comments — just one word each. The facilitator goes last. This method is fast, powerful, and gives a snapshot of the group's collective mood.

Method 4: journaling

Duration: 10 minutes (individual, silent)

How it works: Provide each participant with a notebook at the beginning of the programme (their "learning journal"). At the end of each day, give 10 minutes of quiet time for personal writing. Provide a guiding question or prompt:

- Day 1: "What surprised me today about myself or about others?"
- Day 2: "What challenged my assumptions or beliefs today?"
- Day 3: "What skill did I practise today that I want to continue developing?"
- Day 4: "What is the most important thing I want to remember from this programme?"

Journals are private. Participants are never asked to share what they wrote.

Mid-programme evaluation

When: At the midpoint of your programme (e.g., after Day 2 of a 4-day programme).

Duration: 20 minutes

Purpose: To check in with participants, gather feedback on the programme so far, and make adjustments if needed.

Method: "Four Corners" Feedback

Place four flipchart sheets in four corners of the room, each with a different question:

1. "What is working well? (Keep doing this!)"
2. "What could be improved? (Change this!)"
3. "What is missing? (Add this!)"
4. "How is the group dynamic? (Strengthen this!)"

Participants walk around and write their comments on each flipchart (anonymously). The facilitator team reviews the feedback during a break and presents a summary at the beginning of the next session, along with any adjustments they plan to make.

Final evaluation session plan

Duration: 90 minutes

Group size: 10–30 participants

Materials needed:

- Printed final evaluation questionnaires (see Appendix B)
- Flipchart paper and markers
- Coloured yarn or string (for the "web" activity)
- Individual certificates or Youthpass certificates (if available)

Step-by-step instructions:

1. **(20 min)** "The Learning Line." On a long piece of paper taped to the wall, draw a horizontal timeline representing the programme. Mark each day and key activity. Invite participants to walk along the timeline and add sticky notes: yellow for "most impactful moment," pink for "most challenging moment," blue for "something I learned." This creates a collective visual memory of the programme.

1. **(15 min)** Small group reflection. In groups of 4–5, discuss:

- What were your top 3 learnings from this programme?
- How has your understanding of cultural diversity changed?
- What will you do differently in your daily life as a result of this programme?

- What message do you want to share with other young people?

1. **(15 min)** Individual written evaluation. Distribute the evaluation questionnaire (Appendix B). Allow silent time for individual completion.

1. **(25 min)** "The Web of Connection." Stand in a circle. One person holds a ball of coloured yarn or string. They say something they learned, appreciated, or will remember, then hold onto the end of the yarn and throw the ball to someone else in the circle. That person says something and throws the ball to another person. Continue until everyone has spoken and the group is connected by a web of yarn. The facilitator observes: "Look at this web. This is the connection we have built. Even when we go home, these connections remain."

1. **(15 min)** Closing ceremony. Distribute Youthpass certificates or programme certificates. Share a few final words from the facilitation team. Invite participants to share a final goodbye message. Take a group photo.

Youthpass self-assessment guide

Youthpass recognises learning outcomes in eight key competences. Use this guide in individual conversations with participants or as a self-assessment handout.

For each competence, participants reflect on what they learned during the programme:

1. Multilingual competence

- Did you communicate in a language that is not your mother tongue?
- Did you learn words or phrases in other languages?
- How did you navigate language barriers?

2. Personal, social and learning to learn competence

- What did you learn about yourself?
- How did you manage challenging situations or emotions?
- What social skills did you develop or strengthen?

3. Citizenship competence

- What did you learn about diversity, equality, or human rights?
- How did you participate in group decision-making?
- Did you develop ideas for civic engagement in your community?

4. Entrepreneurship competence

- Did you develop a project idea? What skills did you use?

- Did you take initiative or show creativity?
- What did you learn about turning ideas into action?

5. Cultural awareness and expression competence

- How did you explore your own cultural identity?
- What did you learn about other cultures?
- Did you express yourself creatively?

6. Digital competence

- Did you use digital tools for communication, collaboration, or creation?
- Did you reflect on media literacy or digital content creation?

7. Mathematical competence and competence in science, technology, and engineering

- Did you use analytical thinking or problem-solving?
- Did you work with data or evidence?

8. Literacy competence

- Did you improve your reading, writing, or oral communication skills?
- Did you create written or spoken content?

For each competence, participants write 2–3 sentences describing their learning. These descriptions can be used directly in their Youthpass certificate.

9. Appendices

Appendix A: Template — session planning sheet

Use this blank template to plan your own sessions or to adapt the sessions in this pack.

```
Session planning sheet

Session Title: ____________________________________________

Module: ___________________________________________________

Theme: ____________________________________________________

Objectives:
1. _________________________________________________________
2. _________________________________________________________
3. _________________________________________________________

Duration: _________________________________________________

Group Size (min/max): ____________________________________

Materials Needed:
- _________________________________________________________
- _________________________________________________________
- _________________________________________________________
- _________________________________________________________
- _________________________________________________________

Room Setup:
_____________________________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________

Step-by-Step Instructions:

Step 1 (__ min): ___________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________

Step 2 (__ min): ___________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________

Step 3 (__ min): ___________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________

Step 4 (__ min): ___________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________

Step 5 (__ min): ___________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________
_____________________________________________________________
```

```
Debriefing/Reflection Questions:
1. ____________________________________________________
2. ____________________________________________________
3. ____________________________________________________
4. ____________________________________________________

Adaptation Tips:
- Different group size: ____________________________________
- Online delivery: ________________________________________
- Participants with fewer opportunities: ____________________

Facilitator Notes:
____________________________________________________
____________________________________________________
____________________________________________________

Materials to Prepare/Print:
____________________________________________________
____________________________________________________
```

Appendix B: Template — participant feedback form

```
Participant feedback form
Cultural Bridges – Pedagogical Activity Evaluation

Date: _____
Activity/Session name: _____

1. How would you rate this session overall?
   [ ] Excellent  [ ] Good  [ ] Average  [ ] Below average  [ ] Poor

2. How relevant was this session to your learning needs?
   [ ] Very relevant  [ ] Relevant  [ ] Somewhat relevant  [ ] Not relevant

3. How would you rate the facilitation?
   [ ] Excellent  [ ] Good  [ ] Average  [ ] Below average  [ ] Poor

4. What did you learn from this session?
   _____
   _____
   _____

5. What was the most valuable part of this session?
   _____
   _____

6. What could be improved?
   _____
   _____

7. How confident do you feel about applying what you learned?
   [ ] Very confident  [ ] Confident  [ ] Somewhat confident  [ ] Not confident

8. Would you recommend this session to other young people?
   [ ] Yes, absolutely  [ ] Yes, with changes  [ ] Maybe  [ ] No

9. Any other comments or suggestions?
   _____
   _____
   _____

Thank you for your feedback!
```

Appendix C: Energiser activities collection

Use these short energiser activities (5–10 minutes each) between sessions to re-energise the group, break the ice, or refocus attention.

Energiser 1: "Zip, Zap, Zop"

Duration: 5 minutes

How: Stand in a circle. One person points to someone else and says "ZIP." That person points to another and says "ZAP." The next person points and says "ZOP." Then back to "ZIP." The pattern is always Zip-Zap-Zop. If someone says the wrong word or hesitates, they do a funny dance and the game restarts. Speed up gradually.

Energiser 2: "Fruit Salad"

Duration: 8 minutes

How: Sit in a circle of chairs (one fewer chair than participants). One person stands in the middle. Assign each person a fruit (apple, banana, orange — repeating in a cycle). The person in the middle calls a fruit name — all people with that fruit must stand and find a new seat. The person left without a seat is the new caller. If someone calls "FRUIT SALAD," everyone moves.

Energiser 3: "Human Knot"

Duration: 10 minutes

How: Stand in a tight circle, shoulder to shoulder. Everyone reaches into the centre and grabs two different hands (not the person directly next to them). Without letting go of hands, the group must untangle themselves into a circle. This requires communication, patience, and teamwork.

Energiser 4: "Evolution"

Duration: 8 minutes

How: Everyone starts as an "egg" (crouching down). To evolve, you play rock-paper-scissors with someone at the same stage. The winner evolves to the next stage; the loser stays. Stages: Egg (crouching) > Chicken (flapping arms) > Dinosaur (stomping) > Superhero (hands on hips) > Enlightened Being (sitting down peacefully). You can only play against someone at the same stage. Each stage has a corresponding physical movement that makes it easy to find others at your level.

Energiser 5: "Counting Together"

Duration: 5 minutes

How: The group must count from 1 to 20, with each number said by a different person. If two people speak at the same time, the group starts over from 1. No planning, no system — just intuition and group awareness. This is a powerful group cohesion activity.

Energiser 6: "Gesture Name Circle"

Duration: 7 minutes

How: Stand in a circle. Each person says their name with a gesture or movement (e.g., a jump, a wave, a spin). The whole group repeats the name and gesture together. Go around the full circle. Then, try to go around the circle remembering everyone's name and gesture from memory.

Energiser 7: "Line Up"

Duration: 5 minutes

How: Without speaking (in complete silence), the group must line up in order by a given criterion. Examples: by birthday (January to December), by height (shortest to tallest), by the number of languages they speak, by the distance from their home to this venue. Communication must be non-verbal only.

Energiser 8: "World Music Freeze Dance"

Duration: 7 minutes

How: Play music from different countries. When the music plays, everyone dances. When it stops, everyone freezes. Anyone who moves after the freeze is "out" and becomes a judge. Play music from the countries represented in the group for extra fun and cultural sharing.

Energiser 9: "Speed Dating Questions"

Duration: 8 minutes

How: Participants form two lines facing each other. Give a question (e.g., "What is the strangest food you have ever tried?" or "If you could have dinner with any person in history, who would it be?"). Each pair has 1 minute to discuss. Then one line shifts one position, so everyone has a new partner. Repeat with a new question.

Energiser 10: "The Wind Blows"

Duration: 7 minutes

How: Sit in a circle of chairs (one fewer than participants). One person stands in the middle and says: "The wind blows for everyone who..." and adds something true about themselves (e.g., "...has been to more than two countries," "...speaks more than two languages," "...has a brother or sister"). Everyone for whom the statement is true must stand and find a new chair. The person left standing makes the next statement. This is an excellent intercultural discovery energiser.

Appendix D: recommended reading and online resources

Books

- **"Intercultural Learning — T-Kit No. 4"** — Council of Europe and European Commission. The foundational reference for intercultural learning in youth work. Available free online at pjp-eu.coe.int.
- **"All Different, All Equal — Education Pack"** — Council of Europe. A comprehensive collection of activities for intercultural education, human rights, and participation. Available free online.
- **"Non-Violent Communication: A Language of Life"** by Marshall B. Rosenberg. The definitive guide to NVC, with practical exercises and examples.
- **"The Culture Map"** by Erin Meyer. An accessible guide to understanding cultural differences in communication, leadership, and collaboration.
- **"Why I'm No Longer Talking to White People About Race"** by Reni Eddo-Lodge. A powerful exploration of structural racism and privilege.
- **"Americanah"** by Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie. A novel that illuminates themes of identity, migration, and belonging. Excellent for stimulating discussion.

Online resources

- **SALTO-YOUTH Toolbox (www.salto-youth.net/tools/toolbox/)** — A searchable database of hundreds of non-formal education activities for youth work, including intercultural learning, inclusion, and participation activities.
- **Compass: Manual for Human Rights Education with Young People (Council of Europe)** — Available free at www.coe.int/compass. An essential resource for human rights education activities.
- **Learning to Live Together — An Intercultural and Interfaith Programme for Ethics Education (Arigatou International)** — Available at ethicseducationforchildren.org.

- **Youthpass (www.youthpass.eu)** — The official Youthpass website with guides, examples, and the certificate generation tool.
- **European Youth Portal (europa.eu/youth)** — Information about opportunities, rights, and resources for young people in Europe.
- **EPALE — Electronic Platform for Adult Learning in Europe (epale.ec.europa.eu)** — Resources and community for adult educators, including intercultural education.
- **TED Talks on Intercultural Competence:**
- Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie, "The Danger of a Single Story" (2009)
- Taiye Selasi, "Don't Ask Where I'm From, Ask Where I'm a Local" (2014)
- Pellegrino Riccardi, "Cross-Cultural Communication" (2014)

Organisations and networks

- **Council of Europe Youth Department** — pjp-eu.coe.int
- **SALTO-YOUTH Resource Centres** — www.salto-youth.net
- **Anna Lindh Euro-Mediterranean Foundation for the Dialogue between Cultures** — www.annalindhfoundation.org
- **Fundacja Porta (Poland)** — A foundation promoting integration and intercultural dialogue. Presented during the Cultural Bridges Warsaw exchange, May 2025.

Appendix E: glossary of key terms

Culture: The shared beliefs, values, customs, behaviours, and artefacts that characterise a group or society. Culture is learned, dynamic, and multifaceted — it is not limited to nationality or ethnicity.

Discrimination: The unjust or prejudicial treatment of different categories of people, especially on the grounds of ethnicity, age, sex, disability, religion, or sexual orientation. Discrimination can be individual (interpersonal actions) or structural (embedded in laws, policies, or institutions).

Diversity: The presence of difference within a given setting. Diversity includes but is not limited to differences in ethnicity, nationality, language, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, disability, socioeconomic background, and worldview.

Empathy: The ability to understand and share the feelings of another. In intercultural contexts, empathy involves trying to see a situation from another person's cultural perspective, even when it differs significantly from one's own.

Ethnicity: A category of people who identify with each other based on shared ancestry, language, history, society, culture, or nation.

Eurocentrism: The tendency to view the world from a European perspective, often assuming that European cultural norms, values, and historical experiences are universal or superior.

Exclusion (social): A process by which individuals or groups are wholly or partially excluded from full participation in the society in which they live. Social exclusion can be economic, political, cultural, or spatial.

Hate speech: Any kind of communication in speech, writing, or behaviour that attacks or uses pejorative or discriminatory language with reference to a person or a group on the basis of who they are.

Inclusion (social): The process of improving the terms of participation in society for people who are disadvantaged on the basis of age, sex, disability, ethnicity, origin, religion, economic status, or other factors.

Intercultural competence: The ability to communicate effectively and appropriately in intercultural situations based on one's intercultural knowledge, skills, and attitudes (Deardorff, 2006).

Intercultural dialogue: An open and respectful exchange of views between individuals and groups with different ethnic, cultural, religious, and linguistic backgrounds and heritage, on the basis of mutual understanding and respect (Council of Europe).

Interculturality: The existence and equitable interaction of diverse cultures and the possibility of generating shared cultural expressions through dialogue and mutual respect.

Intersectionality: A framework for understanding how different aspects of a person's social and political identities (e.g., gender, race, class, sexuality, disability) combine to create unique modes of discrimination and privilege.

Microaggression: Brief, everyday exchanges that send denigrating messages to certain individuals because of their group membership. Often unintentional.

Non-formal education (NFE): Planned, structured programmes and processes of personal and social education for young people designed to improve a range of skills and competences, outside the formal educational curriculum. NFE is voluntary, learner-centred, and participatory.

Prejudice: Preconceived opinion that is not based on reason or actual experience. A bias, especially a negative one, toward a group of people.

Privilege: Unearned advantages that benefit members of certain social groups at the expense of others. Privilege is often invisible to those who have it.

Racism: Prejudice, discrimination, or antagonism directed against a person or people on the basis of their membership in a particular racial or ethnic group, typically one that is a minority or marginalised. Racism can be individual (personal attitudes and actions) or structural/systemic (embedded in institutions and policies).

Safe space: A supportive, non-threatening environment where all participants feel comfortable to express themselves, explore their identities, and engage with challenging topics without fear of judgement, discrimination, or retaliation.

Stereotype: A widely held, fixed, and oversimplified image or idea of a particular type of person or group. Stereotypes can be positive or negative, but both reduce complex individuals to simplified categories.

Xenophobia: Dislike of or prejudice against people from other countries or cultures.

Youthpass: A European recognition tool for identifying and documenting learning outcomes from Erasmus+ Youth and European Solidarity Corps projects. It is part of the European Commission's strategy to foster the recognition of non-formal learning.

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